Ardoch Development Trust (ADT)
Grant Application Guidance for Applicants

This guidance document is designed to help residents, community groups, and organisations successfully apply for ADT funding. It explains what is required, how applications are assessed, and how to maximise your chances of approval.

1. Grant Tiers

Tier 1 (Up to £1,000): Simple application, quick decision (3–10 days). Ideal for small or pilot projects.
Tier 2 (Over £1,000): More detailed application, decision in 4–6 weeks. Suitable for larger or long-term projects.

2. What ADT is Looking For

- Clear benefit to the local community
- Alignment with Community Action Plan (CAP) priorities
- Strong evidence of need
- Inclusive and fair access
- Good value for money
- Realistic and deliverable plans

3. How Applications are Scored

Applications are scored out of 100 using six criteria. Each is scored 0–3 and weighted.
Approval thresholds:
- ≥66% = Approved
- 50–65% = Conditional
- <50% = Not approved

Most successful applications clearly demonstrate strong community benefit, clear CAP alignment, and good evidence.

4. Scoring Criteria Explained

Local Benefit & Reach (25%) – Explain who benefits and how many. Strong applications show wide and ongoing impact.

CAP Alignment (20%) – Clearly link your project to specific CAP priorities and explain the connection.

Impact & Legacy (20%) – Show long-term benefit and how the project will continue beyond initial funding.

Inclusivity & Fairness (15%) – Ensure access for all groups and remove barriers where possible.

Value for Money (10%) – Provide clear budgets and demonstrate efficient use of funds.

Deliverability (10%) – Show a clear plan, responsible people, and realistic timelines.

5. Completing Your Application

Provide clear and concise answers for each section:
• Project description – what, why, who benefits
• Evidence of need – feedback, surveys, support
• Budget – clear breakdown and justification
• Delivery – timeline and responsibilities
• Outcomes – what success looks like

6. Tier 1 vs Tier 2 Requirements

Tier 1 requires a simple description, basic budget, and short report after completion.
Tier 2 requires detailed planning, evidence, full budget breakdown, risk assessment, and ongoing reporting.

7. Top Tips for Success

• Use numbers to demonstrate impact
• Clearly link to CAP priorities
• Show long-term value
• Provide evidence, not just statements
• Include partnerships where possible

8. Final Checklist

Before submitting:
• Clear community benefit
• Strong CAP alignment
• Realistic budget
• Deliverable plan
• Evidence of need